THE TATTVAYOGABINDU OF RĀMACANDRA

Critical Edition and Annotated Translation of an Early Modern Text on Rājayoga, with a Comparative Analysis of the Complex Yoga Taxonomies from the Same Period



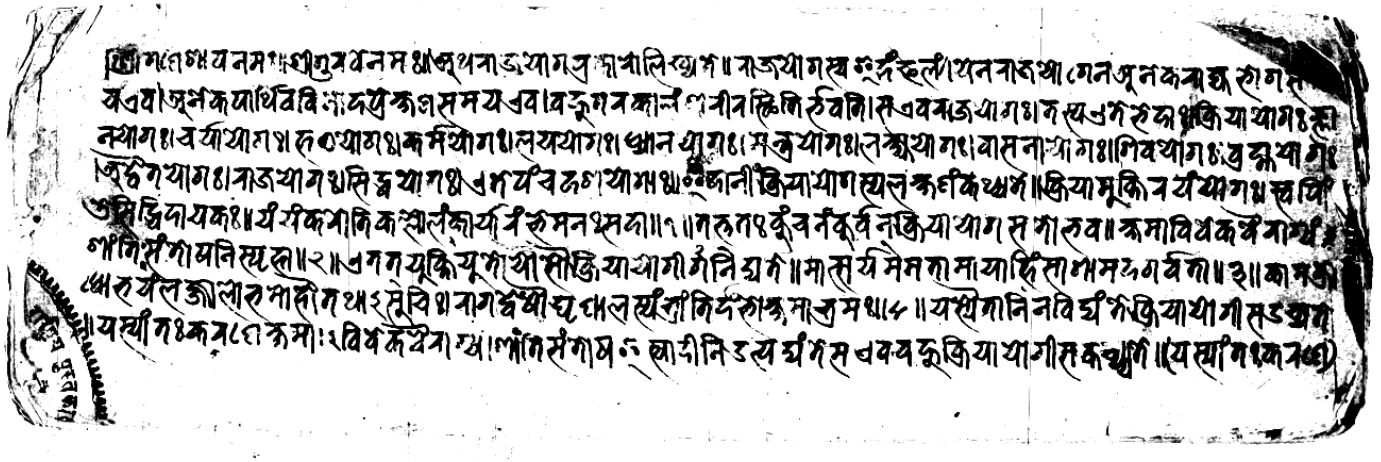


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Chapter 1

Introduction

Chapter 2

The *Tattvayogabindu* of Rāmacandra

Critical Edition & Annotated Translation

[XIII. **lakṣyayogaḥ**]

इदानीं सुखसाध्यो लक्ष्ययोगः कथ्यते। अस्य लक्ष्ययोगस्य पञ्चभेदा भवन्ति। १ ऊर्ध्वलक्ष्यम्। २ अधोलक्ष्यम्। ३ बाह्यलक्ष्यम्। ४ मध्यलक्ष्यम्। ५ अन्तरलक्ष्य–म्॥

Sources: 2–4 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 833): sukhasādhyaṃ lakṣayogam idānīṃ śṛṇu pārvati | pañcadhā lakṣayogaś ca ūrddhalakṣādibhedataḥ (*ūrdhva* YK 2.1) ‖ ūrddhalakṣam (*ūrdhva* YK 2.2) adholakṣo (*°lakṣaṃ* YK 2.2) bāhyalakṣaṃ (*vāhya°* YK 2.2) tathaiva ca | madhyalakṣas (*°lakṣaṃ* YK 2.2) tathā jñeyam antarlakṣas (*°lakṣaṃ* YK 2.2) tathaiva ca |

Testimonia: 2–4 cf. *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f.124r ll. 7–9): atha rājayogāṃgasukhasādhyo lakṣyayogaḥ kathyate ‖ lakṣayogasya paṃcabhedāṃ bhavati | parā ūrdhvalakṣyāṃ bāhyalakṣyaṃ madhyalakṣyam antaralakṣyaṃ ceti |

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2 **°sādhyo** cett.] °sādhya N_2, °sādhyopa° U_1, °sādho PB, °sādhe L **lakṣyayogaḥ** cett.] lakṣanayogaḥ N_2, °lakṣayogaḥ U_1, lakṣayogaḥ LB **asya** γ] *om.* β **lakṣya°** cett.] lakṣana° N_2, alakṣa° JU_1, lakṣa° U_2LB **pañcabhedā** cett.] paṃcabhedāḥ L, paṃce bhedāḥ B **bhavanti** cett.] bhavati N_2U_1, bhaṃvaṃti K_1, bhavaṃtī B 3 **ūrdhvalakṣyam** PE] urdhvalakṣya N_1DK_1J, urdhvalakṣa N_2U_1, ūrdhvalakṣam N_2LB **°lakṣyam** PE] °lakṣya N_1DK_1J, °lakṣa N_2, *om.* U_1, °lakṣam U_2LB **bāhyalakṣyam** U_2] bāhyalakṣya N_1DK_1J, bāhyalakṣa N_2, bāhyalakya U_1, madhyalakṣyam P, lakṣyam E, madhyalakṣam L, bāhyakṣam B **madhyalakṣyam** em.] madhyalakṣya N_1DK_1J, madhyalakṣa N_2U_1, bāhyalakṣyam PE, madhyalakṣaṃ U_2, bāhyakṣam L, *om.* B 3–4 **antaralakṣyam** PE] antaralakṣya $N_1DK_1JU_1$, antaralakṣa N_2, sarvalakṣyam U_2, aṃtaralakṣam LB

[XIII. **Lakṣyayoga**]

Now, Lakṣyayoga ("Yoga of foci"),[1] which is easily accomplished,[2] is explained. There are five subdivisions of this Lakṣyayoga: 1. The upper focus (*ūrdhvalakṣya*), 2. The lower focus (*adholakṣya*), 3. The outer focus (*bāhyalakṣya*), 4. The middle focus (*madhyalakṣya*), 5. The inner focus (*antaralakṣya*).[3,4,5]

[1] The original reading of the yoga is likely *lakṣyayoga* since it is attested across both the β- and γ-groups. This reading is supported by the usage in the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* 2.26–32 and *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā* (Ed. p. 2). However, *Prāṇatoṣinī* (Ed. pp. 833–834) and *Yogakarṇikā* (Ed. pp. 23–24) as well as *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* (Ed. pp. 104–105) use the term *lakṣayoga*, indicating that both designations were common. See p. **??** for a detailed discussion of Lakṣyayoga.

[2] The emphasis on the ease of Lakṣ(y)ayoga is not just shared with the *Yogasvarodaya* but also with Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.25a: *lakṣayoga hai sugam upāī* |

[3] In most other texts it is called *antarlakṣya*, but the *Tattvayogabindu* reads *antaralakṣya* throughout its manuscript tradition. This is confirmed by the *Haṭhasaṅketacandrikā* (cf. sources).

[4] The practices of Lakṣ(y)ayoga in Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.35–36 (Ed. pp. 104–105) are essentially identical, except presented in a different order and subsumed under the category of Haṭhayoga. The *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati*, one of Rāmacandra's central sources, particularly for the second half of his text, describes three almost identical *lakṣya*s in 2.26–31: *antarlakṣya*, *bahirlakṣya* and *madhyamaṃ lakṣyaṃ*.

[5] Nārāyaṇatīrtha, in his *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, does not mention any of the five categories within his descriptions of Lakṣyayoga. Here, Lakṣyayoga is connected to *Yogasūtra* 1.35. Lakṣyayoga directs the mind onto a specific focus, like the tip of the nose, etc., to stop the mind's activity, cf. *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*, Ed. p. 54.

[XIV. **ūrdhvalakṣyam**]

प्रथममूर्ध्वलक्ष्यं कथ्यते। आकाशमध्ये दृष्टिः। अथ च मन ऊर्ध्वं कृत्वा स्थाप्यते। एतस्य लक्ष्यस्य दृढीकरणात्परमेश्वरस्य तेजसा सह दृष्टेरैक्यं भवति। अथ चाकाशमध्ये यः कश्चिददृष्टः पदार्थो भवति। स साधकस्य दृष्टिगोचरे भवति। अयमेवोर्ध्वलक्षयः॥

Sources: 2–5 cf. YSv (PT, pp. 834): lakṣaṇaṃ śrṛṇu caiṣāṃ hi phalaṃ jñātvā maheśvari | ākāśe dṛṣṭim āsthāya mana ūrddhan tu kārayet | ūrdhalakṣaṃ (*ūrdhva°* YK 2.4) bhaved eṣā parameśasya caikatā |

Testimonia: 2–5 cf. *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f.124r l. 9 to f. 124v l. 2): tatra prathamam ūrdhvalakṣyaṃ nirūpyate ākāśamadhye dṛṣṭiḥ athavā mana ūrdhvaṃ kṛtvā sthāpyate tasya lakṣyadṛḍhīkaraṇāt prathamaṃ tamo jyotir nakṣatreṃdrādīnāṃ darśanaṃ tato 'bhyāsad ārḍhye manasthairye krameṇa parameśvarasya tejasā sahadṛṣṭher aikyaṃ bhavati ākāśamadhye yaḥ kaścid dṛṣṭhaḥ padārtho bhavati sa sādhkasya dṛṣṭhigocaro bhavati ‖ ayaṃ ūrdhvalakṣyayogaprakāraḥ

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2 **prathamam** PE] prathamaṃ βU_2, atha L, athama B **ūrdhvalakṣyaṃ** E] urdhvalakṣaḥ $N_1N_2DK_1J$, urdhvalakṣya U_1, ūrdhvalakṣyaḥ P, urdhvalakṣaṃ U_2, ūrdhvalakṣaṃ L, urdhalakṣaṃ B **kathyate** cett.] *om.* LB **ākāśamadhye** cett.] *om.* P **dṛṣṭiḥ** cett.] *om.* P, dṛṣṭi B **atha ca** $N_1N_2U_1$P] atha vā DK_1JLB, atha U_2, kadā ca E **mana ūrdhvaṃ** N_2JPE] mana urdhvaṃ N_1U_2, mana ūrdhaṃ DK_1, manerddhvaṃ U_1, ūrdhvaṃ mana L, ūrdhvamana B **sthāpyate** cett.] sthāpayati E 3 **lakṣyasya** N_1PE] lakṣasya cett., lakṣaṇasya N_2 **dṛḍhīkaraṇāt** cett.] dṛḍhakaraṇāt PE, dṛḍhīkṛtvā LB **tejasā** cett.] tenasā U_2, teja° LB **dṛṣṭer aikyaṃ** JU_1PU_2E] dṛṣṭeḥ aikyaṃ N_1DK_1, dṛṣṭeḥ ekaṃ N_2, dṛṣṭair aikā LB **atha** cett.] athā B 3–4 **cākāśa°** PU_2EB] ca ākāśa° $N_1DK_1JU_1$, ākāśa° N_2, vākāśa° L 4 **kaścid adṛṣṭaḥ** N_1U_1PE] kaścita adṛṣṭaḥ N_2, kaścit adṛṣṭaḥ DK_1J, kaścid dṛṣṭa° U_2, kaccit dṛṣṭaḥ B, kaccit dṛṣṭaḥ B **padārtho** cett.] padārthe N_1K_1, padārtha N_2 **sa** cett.] *om.* N_2U_2LB **dṛṣṭigocare** $N_1DK_1U_2$] dṛṣṭigocaro cett., dṛṣṭigocarā N_2 **bhavati** cett.] bhavatī B **ayam** cett.] atham J 4–5 **evordhvalakṣyaḥ** DU_1PE] evordhvalakṣya N_1U_2, eva vodhalakṣaṇam N_2, evordhvalakṣaḥ L, evordhalakṣaḥ B

[XIV. **The upper focus**]

At first, the upper focus is explained. The gaze is on the centre of the sky.[6] And then, having directed the mind upwards, it is fixed [there]. As a result of stabilising this focus, unity of the gaze with the splendour of the highest lord arises. And then, some object that has not been seen before arises in the centre of the sky. That [object] arises in the range of sight of the practitioner. This alone is the upper focus.[7,8]

[6] This could be the zenith; see *Sanskrit Wörterbuch*, 1858: 179.

[7] Sundardās presents a comparable understanding of *ūrdhvalakṣ(y)a*, namely the practice of fixing the gaze on the sky, in his *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 3.27: *ūrddha lakṣa karai ihīṃ bhāṃtī | duṣtyākāśa rahai dina rātī | bibidha prakāra hoi ujiyārā | gopi padāratha dīsahiṃ sārā ||*

[8] A similar practice is presented in *Vijñānabhairava* 84: *ākāśaṃ vimalam paśyan kṛtvā dṛṣṭiṃ nirantarām | stabdhātmā tatkṣaṇād devi bhairavaṃ vapur āpnuyāt ||* Although the term *lakṣya* is not used, the central elements of the practice are found here: the gaze is constantly fixed on the sky, establishing a connection with the divine. See also *Śivasaṃhitā* 5.30–31.

[XV. **adholakṣyaḥ**]

अथाधोलक्ष्यः। नासिकाया उपरि द्वादशाङ्गुलपर्यंतं दृष्टिः स्थिरा कर्त्तव्या। अथवा नासिकाया अग्रे दृष्टिः स्थिरा कर्त्तव्या। लक्ष्यद्वयस्य दृढीकरणाद्दृष्टिः स्थिरा भवति। पवनः स्थिरो भवति। आयुर्वर्धते॥ एतद्वयमेव बाह्यलक्ष्यमपि कथ्यते। बाह्याभ्य–
5 न्तरमाकाशवत् शून्यलक्ष्यः कर्त्तव्यः। जाग्रद्दशायां चलनदशायां भोजनदशायां स्थितिकाले सर्वस्थाने शून्यस्य ध्यानकारणात् मरणत्रासो न भवति॥

Sources: 2–6 cf. YSv (PT, p. 834): nāsikopari deveśi dvādaśāṅgulamānataḥ | dṛṣṭiḥ sthirā (*dṛṣṭisthiran* YK 2.5) tu karttavyā (*karttavyam* YK 2.5) adholakṣam idaṃ bhaja (*bhajet* YK 2.5) | athavā (*tathā ca* YK 2.5) nāsikāgre tu sthirā dṛṣṭir iyaṃ bhavet (*śṛṇu* YK 2.5) | sthirā dṛṣṭiś cirāyuḥ syāt tathāsau (*yasya bhavet sthirā dṛṣṭiś cirāyuḥ* YK 2.6) sthiradṛṣṭimān | : bāhyalakṣaṃ svayaṃ jñeyaṃ yāti tattvanivāsinām (*°nirāsinām* YK 2.6) | kāmināṃ tu bahir dṛṣṭiś cintādiṣu susiddhidā | etad bāhyamadhyalakṣaṃ iṣṭacintā nirākulam (*dṛṣṭicintānirākulaḥ* YK 2.7) | antarlakṣaṃ śṛṇu śukradigvidigādivarjitam (*subhru°* YK 2.8) | (*bāhyabhyantara ākāśaṃ vādhāmantraṃ paraṃ mataṃ* YK 2.8cd) | calaj jāgratsuṣupteṣu bhojaneṣu ca sarvadā | sarvāvasthāsu deveśi cittaṃ śūnye niyojayet | karttā kārayitā śunyaḥ (*śūnyaṃ* YK 2.10) mūrttimān śūnya īśvaraḥ | harṣaśokaghaṭastho 'yaṃ janmamṛtyū labhet svayam |

Testimonia: 2–6 ≈*Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* (MMPP 2244, f. 124v ll. 2–4): atha adholakṣyayogaḥ nāsikāyā upari dvādaśāṃgulaparyaṃta dṛṣṭiḥ sthirā kartavyā athavā nāsikāyā agre dṛṭhṭiḥ sthirākartavyā lakṣyadvayasya dṛḍhīkaraṇad dṛṣṭiḥ sthirā bhavati pavano pi sthiro bhavati jito bhuvati pavanasthairya mano pi sthiraṃ śāṃtaṃ bhavati lakṣadvayadṛḍhīkaraṇād āyurvṛddhir bhavati | satyam ūrdhvalakṣyavad vāhyalakṣam api kathyate bāhyo abhyaṃtare ākāśavat chonyalakṣaḥ kartavyaḥ jāgrad daśāyāṃ calanadaśāyāṃ ca bhojadaśāyāṃ sthitikāle sarvasthāne śūnyadhyānakaraṇān maraṇā trāso na bhavati |

2 athādholakṣyaḥ em.] atha adholakṣyaḥ N_1, atha adholakṣanaḥ N_2, atha adholakṣaḥ DK_1, atha adholakṣa JU_1, athādholakṣaḥ PL, *om.* U_2E, athādholakṣa B **nāsikāyā** cett.] nāsikāyāḥ U_2E **upari** cett.] upariṣṭāt U_2 **dvādaśāṅgula°** cett.] daśāṃgula° U_2, dvādaśāṃgulamūla° E **dṛṣṭiḥ** cett.] dṛṣṭi° JU_1 **athavā** cett.] *om.* LB **3 nāsikāyā** cett.] nāsika N_2, nāsikāyāḥ JU_1 **agre** cett.] °gre K_1, *om.* LB **dṛṣṭiḥ** cett.] dṛṣṭi° N_2K_1 **sthirā** cett.] *om.* LB **karttavyā** cett.] *om.* LB **lakṣyadvayasya** J] lakṣadvayasya cett., lakṣadūyasya E **dṛḍhīkaraṇād** N_2] dṛḍhīkaraṇāt $N_1DU_1U_2$EL, dṛṣṭīkaraṇāt P, dṛḍhīkaraṇān B **dṛṣṭiḥ** cett.] dṛṣṭi° N_2U_2L **sthirā** cett.] °sthiro L, sthiro B **bhavati** cett.] bhavatī B **4 pavanaḥ** N_1DK_1PE] pavana° $N_2JU_1U_2$, *om.* LB **sthiro bhavati** cett.] *om.* LB **etad dvayam** N_2JPL] etat advayam N_2DK_1, etat dvayam U_1U_2, etad dūyam E, etad dvayadvaya B **eva** β] api γ **°lakṣyam** U_1PU_2E] °lakṣam cett. **api** β] eva γ **kathyate** β] bhavati γ, bhavatī B **4–5 bāhyābhyantaram** N_2] bāhyo bhyaṃtaraṃ N_1DK_1, bāhyābhyaṃtare JU_1PU_2LB, bāhyāṃtara E **5 ākāśavat** β] ākāśe cet PU_2, ākāśe E, ākāśa cen L, ākāśacvat B **°lakṣyaḥ** $N_1DK_1JU_1$] °lakṣaḥ N_2, °lakṣyaṃ PU_2E, °ṃ lakṣaṃ LB **karttavyaḥ** cett.] karttavyā LB **jāgraddaśāyāṃ** cett.] jāgṛddaśāyāṃ N_2, jāyadaśāyāṃ N_2, jāgradādidaśāyāṃ LB **calana°** cett.] cakaba° N_1 **bhojanadaśāyāṃ** cett.] *om.* JU_1, bhojanaṃ daśāyāṃ P **6 °sthāne** cett.] °sthāneṣu LB **°trāso** N_1DK_1J] °trāśo N_2, °sautrāṃ U_1, *om.* γ **na** cett.] *om.* γ **bhavati** N_1N_2] bhavati ‖ śūnya D, bhavati ‖ cha‖ J, bhavati vā U_1, *om.* γ

[XV. **The lower focus**]

Now, the lower focus. One should stabilize the gaze up to twelve finger breadths above the nose. Alternatively, one should stabilize the gaze onto the tip of the nose. The gaze becomes still due to the stabilising of the two foci. The breath becomes stable. Lifespan increases.[9,10] This pair is also taught as an external focus.[11] [Then] the focus of emptiness, which is like space, should be executed internally and externally.[12] The fear of death does not arise due to meditation on the void in all states—while eating, moving, waking [and] at the time of rest.[13,14]

[9] In Sundardās's *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā* 2.26 (Ed. p. 104), one finds the following verse with a similar concept. He shares the technique of fixing the gaze onto the nose and the notion of the breath becoming stabilised: *prathamahīṃ adho lakṣa kauṃ jānaiṃ | nāśā agra dṛṣṭi sthira ānaiṃ | yātoṃ mana pavanā thira hoī | adho lakṣa jo sādhai koī ||*

[10] In his *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā*, Sundaradeva adds further techniques to the category of *adholakṣya* at this point of the text. For the reconstructed passage (based on ORI B220, GOML R3239, and MMPP 2244) and its translation, see p. **??**.

[11] This statement associates the two practices of *adholakṣya* with *bāhyalakṣya*, which is described later in the text. Indeed, these later descriptions instruct the practitioner to focus on one of the five elements at various distances in front of the nose or above the head (cf. p. **??**).

[12] The description undoubtedly derives from the *Yogasvarodaya* as quoted in the *Prāṇatoṣinī* (Ed. p. 834), where it is declared a practice of *antaralakṣ(y)a*. Rāmacandra extracts this passage from his source text and locates this practice within the *adholakṣya* category.

[13] The translation of *sthitikāle* as "time of rest" is confirmed by the four states mentioned in the YSv (cf. sources). The formulation *sthitikāle* is Rāmacandra's rendering of *suṣupteṣu*.

[14] The concept of five *lakṣ(y)a*s appears only in the lost *Yogasvarodaya* and from there made its way into *Prāṇatoṣinī*, *Yogakarṇikā* and *Tattvayogabindu*. Other texts that include it are *Sarvāṅgayogapradīpikā*, *Haṭhasaṃketacandrikā* and *Yogasiddhāntacandrikā*. In those texts, it is treated as a distinct type of yoga: Lakṣ(y)oga. If one encounters the concept of three *lakṣ(y)a* as found in *Netratantra with Netroddyota* (cf. 7.1), *Śivayogapradīpikā* (cf. 4.36–50), *Maṇḍalabrāhmaṇopaniṣat* (cf. 2.6–2.14) or *Advayatārakopaniṣad* (Ed. pp. 3–5) etc. it is never presented as a distinct type of yoga.

Chapter 3

Appendix

3.1 Figures



Figure 2: The *dehasvarūpa* of *ajapāgāyatrī*. The image, reminiscent of a hippogriff, is part of an illustrated Sanskrit manuscript written in the Śāradā script. Preserved as a single large scroll under Acc. No. 1334 at the Oriental Institute in Srinagar (Kashmir), it is entitled *Nāḍīcakra*. The manuscript contains a depiction of the yogic body's *cakra*s and *nāḍī*s. The text surrounding the figure closely corresponds to the additional material found in manuscript U_2 of the *Tattvayogabindu*. The manuscript reads (diplomatic transcription): *oṃ daśame pūrṇagiripīṭhe lalāṭamaṇḍale candro devatā amṛtāśaktiḥ paramātmā ṛṣiḥ dvāviṃśaddalāni amṛtavāsinikalā 4: ambikā 1 lambikā 2 gha(ṃ)ṭkā 3 tālikā 4 dehasvarūpaṃ kākamukhaṃ 1 naranetraṃ 2 gośṛṅgaṃ 3 lalāṭabrahmapara 4 hayagrīvā 5 mayūramuścaṃ 6 haṃsacārītani 7 sthāna.*



Figure 3: Viṣṇu Viśvarūpa, India, Rajasthan, Jaipur, ca. 1800–1820, Opaque watercolor and gold on paper, 38.5 × 28 cm, Victoria and Albert Museum, London, Given by Mrs. Gerald Clark.



Figure 4: The Equivalence of Self and Universe (detail), folio 6 from the *Siddhasiddhāntapaddhati* (Bulaki), India, Rajasthan, Jodhpur, 1824 (Samvat 1881), 122 x 46 cm, RJS 2378, Mehragarh Museum Trust.

Chapter 4

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